Billing Guide

How Salesmsg credits work

Exactly how credits are calculated for every message — so your balance never surprises you.

1 SMS segment = 1 credit

Inbound messages use credits too.

The basics

Character	Every letter, number, space and symbol in your message counts.
GSM-7	Standard text character set — A–Z, 0–9 and common punctuation. Fits 160 characters per segment.
Unicode (UCS-2)	Expanded set for emojis, accented letters and non-Latin scripts. Fits only 70 characters per segment.
Segment	One billed unit of a text. Long messages split into segments automatically by the carrier.
Credit	The unit deducted from your balance. One segment = one credit.

Segment limits by encoding

GSM-7 — plain text

160 characters = 1 credit

153 per segment on long messages

Unicode — emojis & special characters

70 characters = 1 credit

67 per segment on long messages

One emoji switches the whole message

A single emoji or accented character anywhere switches the entire message to Unicode — not just the part after it. A short message can cost 2 credits.

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What everything costs

Every activity deducts credits — inbound messages cost the same as outbound.

Activity rates

Activity	Credits	Notes
SMS	1 per segment	Inbound and outbound; 160 chars/segment plain text, 70 with emojis.
MMS (picture or media)	2 per message	Flat rate, regardless of length.
RCS	2 per message	Same as MMS, including international. Failed RCS messages are still charged.
Ringless voicemail	2 per drop	Flat rate per voicemail delivered.
Calling	From 1 per min	Standard U.S.: 1/min. Toll-free and international cost more — see rates.
Call forwarding	2 per minute	Charged from when ringing starts, whether answered or not.
Transcription	1 per minute	Applies to calls and voicemails, including the AI summary.
AI agent messages	+2 per message	On top of the normal SMS, MMS or RCS cost.

Calling and international rates vary

Toll-free inbound: 3 credits/min. Alaska (907) is 5 credits/min outbound. International rates vary by country — Salesmsg covers 236 countries. Full rate list in the Help Center.

Credits aren't carrier fees

Carriers add their own per-message surcharges; 10DLC registration has its own fees. Both appear as separate invoice lines — not deducted from your credit balance.

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Your balance and worked examples

What rolls over, what stops at zero, and how credits add up in practice.

What rolls over, what doesn't

Plan credits	Reset on your billing anniversary. Annual credits granted in full on the renewal date.
Purchased credits	Roll over — auto-recharge top-ups and one-off purchases stay until you spend them.
At zero	Messages and calls stop until you top up. Set up auto-recharge to stay online.
Inbound at zero	Contacts can still text you, taking your balance negative. Shortfall deducted from your next purchase.
Broadcasts	Salesmsg checks your balance first and prompts you to top up before sending.

Worked examples

Three-segment text

3 segments × 1 credit

3 credits

MMS with a photo

Flat MMS rate

2 credits

Two-minute call, transcribed

2 (call) + 2 (transcription)

4 credits

Ringless voicemail drop

Flat rate per drop

2 credits

AI agent reply, one segment

1 (SMS) + 2 (AI)

3 credits

Contact texts you back

1 inbound segment

1 credit

The carrier splits long messages into segments; the recipient sees them as one. Credits are based on actual segments transmitted, which the composer shows before you send.

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Tips and quick answers

Simple habits to save credits plus answers to the most common billing questions.

Keeping messages to one credit

Keep it short. Stay under 160 characters. Skip emojis — one drops the limit to 70. Curly quotes and em dashes switch to Unicode too.

Watch the counter. The composer shows segment count before you send — check on broadcasts and templates. Paste as plain text to avoid hidden characters from Word or Docs.

When you're not charged

Situation	Charged?	Why
Texts from unverified toll-free number	**No**	Message never leaves the platform.
Inbound calls from blocked contact	**No**	Call rejected before it connects.
A failed RCS message	**Yes**	RCS is billed on the attempt, including fallbacks to SMS/MMS.

Quick answers

Why did a short message cost 2 credits?

A Unicode character — an emoji, accented letter, or curly quote — switched the whole message to a 70-character limit.

Do contacts' replies cost us credits?

Yes. Inbound messages bill at the same rate as outbound, and keep arriving even when your balance hits zero.

Do unused credits carry forward?

Plan credits reset each billing period. Auto-recharge top-ups and other separately purchased credits roll over until spent.